SwiftHaul Logistics — Carrier & Lane Performance

Analytical summary · Kashad · October 2026 · Data: 1,500,000 shipments, ship dates 2024-01-01 to 2026-01-03, BigQuery dataset *swifthaul* (row count and date range from the validation queries in 01_load_shipments.sql)

Key takeaways

• **SwiftHaul Ground is the best-value carrier**: the cheapest Ground option ($3.374/kg) and the most reliable (93.17% on-time).

• **Reliability spans 14 points**, from Skyliner Air (95.19%) to OceanLink (81.18%), and each carrier is consistent month to month.

• **Lane cost is driven by distance**: intercontinental lanes average about $403 per shipment versus about $304 for domestic US lanes.

1. Which carriers are the most and least reliable?

Skyliner Air is the most reliable carrier at 95.19% on-time; OceanLink is the least reliable at 81.18%, a gap of 14.01 percentage points. Rankings are stable: Skyliner's worst month (94.82%) is still better than every other carrier's average, and OceanLink's best month (81.86%) is still the lowest in the network. These are persistent carrier characteristics, not one-off bad periods.

Carrier	Shipments	On-time %	Worst month %	Best month %
Skyliner Air	250,025	95.19	94.82	95.58
SwiftHaul Ground	250,269	93.17	92.69	93.59
MetroCourier	249,964	92.14	91.74	92.50
Continental Cargo	249,989	89.13	88.69	89.65
BlueLine Freight	249,669	87.24	86.21	87.95
OceanLink	250,084	81.18	78.59	81.86

Source: Q1 in 07_analysis.sql, reading view *v_carrier_ontime*. Overall rate = SUM(on_time_shipments) / SUM(total_shipments), not an average of monthly rates.

2. Which lanes are the most expensive on average?

The most expensive lane is APAC-East → US-Central at $403.31 per shipment. The ten most expensive lanes sit in a narrow $401.78–$403.31 band, and every one of them crosses continents. The cheapest lanes stay within the US: US-West → US-Central averages $304.43. The most expensive lane therefore costs $98.88 (32%) more than the cheapest. Distance is the main driver, which fits the freight cost model's per-km charge. Each lane carries a similar volume (about 26,600–27,000 shipments), so the averages are equally reliable.

Rank	Lane	Avg cost (USD)	Avg cost/kg (USD)	Shipments
1	APAC-East → US-Central	403.31	5.251	26,719
2	US-West → APAC-South	402.96	5.260	26,706
3	EU-West → APAC-South	402.85	5.137	26,581
4	APAC-East → EU-Central	402.41	5.305	26,983
5	US-East → APAC-East	402.20	5.326	26,873
…	Cheapest: US-West → US-Central	304.43	—	—

Source: Q2 (ten most expensive) and Q2b (cheapest) in 07_analysis.sql, reading view *v_cost_per_lane*.

3. How do carriers compare on cost vs. reliability?

Cost per kg (freight_cost_usd ÷ weight_kg, averaged) is used so carriers are compared fairly across shipment sizes. Comparisons are made within each transport mode, because Air, Ground and Ocean are different services.

Carrier	Mode	On-time %	Cost/kg (USD)	Avg cost/shipment (USD)
MetroCourier	Air	92.14	6.479	617.58
Skyliner Air	Air	95.19	7.314	713.32
SwiftHaul Ground	**Ground**	**93.17**	**3.374**	**221.61**
BlueLine Freight	Ground	87.24	3.514	243.28
Continental Cargo	Ground	89.13	3.826	279.28
OceanLink	Ocean	81.18	2.868	166.00

Source: Q3 in 07_analysis.sql, reading view *v_shipments_enriched* (shipments joined to external table *carrier_rates_ext* for mode).

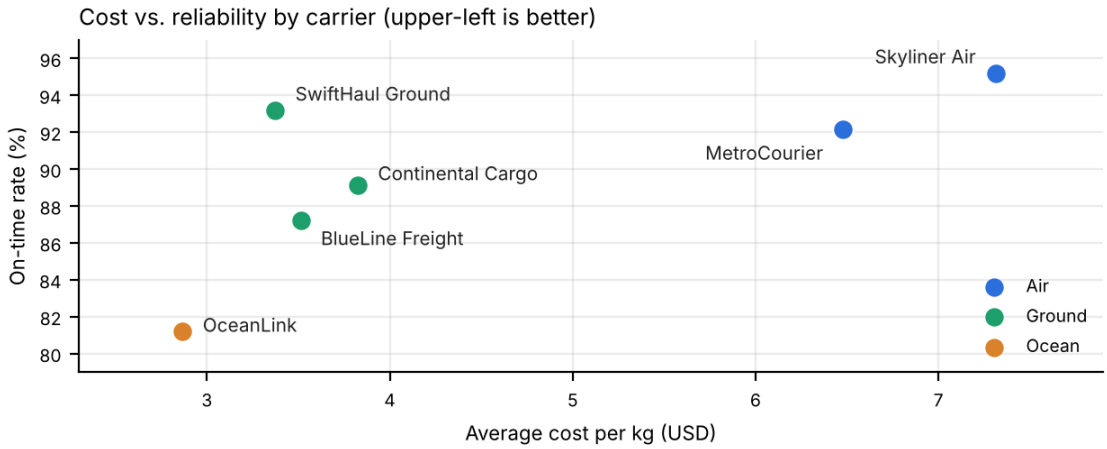


Figure 1. Each carrier's cost per kg vs. on-time rate (data: Q3).

Ocean is the cheapest mode at $2.868/kg, but OceanLink has the worst on-time rate of any carrier (81.18%). **Air** is the most expensive mode; within it, Skyliner Air has the best on-time rate (95.19%), at $0.835/kg (12.9%) more than MetroCourier for +3.05 points. **Ground** offers the best balance: SwiftHaul Ground delivers 93.17% on-time at $3.374/kg. Within Ground there is no trade-off at all. SwiftHaul Ground is cheaper than BlueLine Freight by $0.140/kg (4.0%) while being 5.93 points more reliable, and cheaper than Continental Cargo by $0.452/kg (11.8%) while being 4.04 points more reliable. Yet the three Ground carriers each carry about 250,000 shipments, so roughly two-thirds of Ground volume goes to carriers that are both more expensive and less reliable.

Recommendation

- **Make SwiftHaul Ground the default Ground carrier.** Shift volume from BlueLine Freight and Continental Cargo, which are dominated on both cost and reliability. Move volume in stages and keep a secondary Ground carrier under contract, so capacity limits or service disruptions don't put all Ground freight at risk.
- **Use Skyliner Air for time-critical Air shipments**, where its 95.19% on-time rate justifies the 12.9% premium per kg. Keep MetroCourier (92.14%) for Air shipments where cost matters more than the last few points of reliability.
- **Keep OceanLink for cost-sensitive, non-urgent freight only.** It is the cheapest option per kg, but its 81.18% on-time rate means it should not carry shipments with firm delivery commitments.

Limitations

This is an observational comparison. Service level (Economy / Standard / Express), weight and lane mix differ between carriers and could affect both cost and on-time rate. A next step would be to compare carriers within the same service level and lane before reallocating volume. On-time is taken as provided in the data (on_time flag) and was not recomputed.